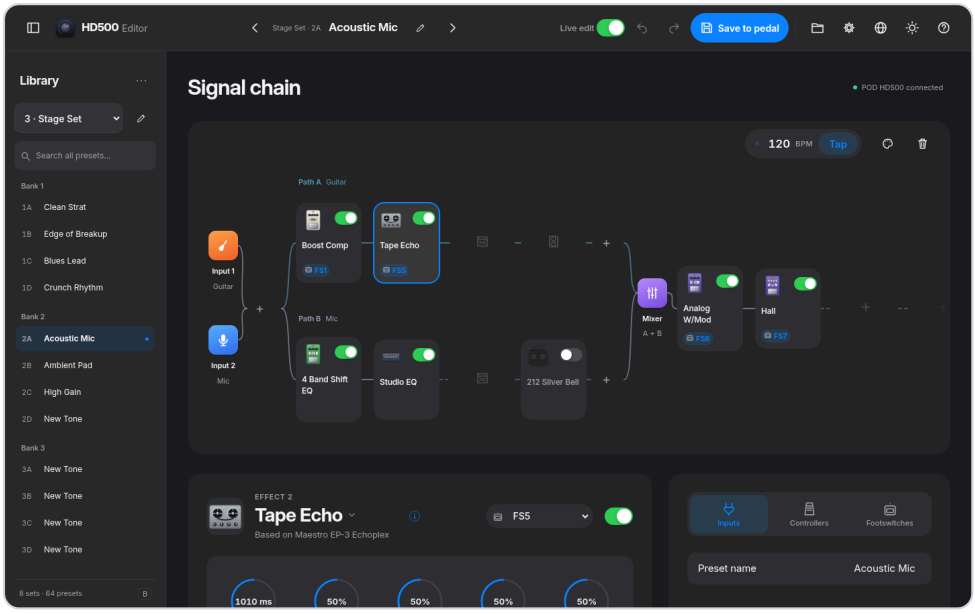
HD500 Editor Linux (Ubuntu/Debian)

Installation and user guide · Version 0.2.12 (beta)

HD500 Editor is a free, open editor for the Line 6 POD HD500 that talks to the pedal directly over USB. It edits amps, cabs, effects, mixer, footswitches and expression pedals live, and manages the 8 libraries of 64 presets.



Limitations

- **Audio:** the pedal works as a sound card through the kernel driver, including while the editor is open. To record the input, open playback at the same time (DAWs do this on their own); capturing alone, with no playback open, gives an I/O error.
- **udev rule:** it grants local users USB access to the pedal.
- Tested on Ubuntu with a real POD HD500. Other distributions should work, with no guarantee.

Installation

1. Download the **.deb** (recommended on Ubuntu/Debian) or the **.AppImage** from the project's releases page.
2. With the .deb: `sudo apt install ./HD500-Editor-<version>.deb`. The udev rule that gives access to the pedal is installed for you.
3. With the AppImage (needs `libfuse2` / `libfuse2t64`): install the rule once — the app's assistant does it with your password, or run `sudo cp 99-line6-hd500.rules /etc/udev/rules.d/ && sudo udevadm control --reload`.
4. Unplug and re-plug the pedal's USB cable, then open HD500 Editor.

Uninstalling the .deb removes the udev rule.

How to use it

Connect
Switch the pedal on, plug in the USB cable and open the program. It connects by itself; if something is missing, the connection assistant shows the step and a button to fix it.

Pick and edit
Choose a preset in the sidebar (**B** opens the library, **L** searches all presets). Click a block in the chain to edit its parameters; drag blocks before/after the amp and between paths A and B (**Alt + arrows** moves by keyboard).

Live editing
With **Live editing** on, every change is heard on the pedal at once. Nothing is written to the pedal's memory until you press **Save to pedal**.

Compare and undo
Compare switches between the saved version and your edits. Undo and redo are in the top bar.

Tempo
The **Tap** button (or the **T** key) sets the preset tempo; changing the tempo on the pedal updates the editor.

Library
In the sidebar's **…** menu: rename sets, copy, swap, clear, drag between slots, export and import the whole library and official **.h5e** presets.

Backups
Before every write the slot's previous content is stored. File ▸ Backups restores it.

AI (optional)
Pedal settings has a switch for the AI assistant (MCP). Leave it off if you do not use it.

Your presets are safe

- Edits only touch the edit buffer; the pedal's memory changes only when you save.
- Switching presets with unsaved edits asks first.
- Every write backs up what was in the slot.

Common problems

"POD HD500 not found"	USB cable, pedal switched on, another program using the pedal (close Line 6's official editor).
"No permission" (Linux)	Install the udev rule (assistant button, or see Installation) and re-plug the cable.
"WinUSB driver" (Windows)	Run Zadig as described under Installation. If Line 6's audio driver is installed it owns the pedal and the editor cannot connect.
The app says connected but nothing answers	Unplug and re-plug the cable; the app recovers the connection by itself.

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